

Australian dwelling prices: hot and cold

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Jan Cotality home value index: +0.6%*mt*h; +9.6%*yr*



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The Cotality home value index rose 0.6% in Feb, following a 0.7% in Jan, a 0.4% rise in Dec and 0.9-1.2% gains over the previous four months. Annual growth ticked up to 9.6%*yr*.

The Feb update confirms that the changed interest rate outlook has seen a significant slowing in price growth and a pull-back in turnover. That said, both have been relatively resilient.

The shift is very much concentrated in the Sydney and Melbourne markets where price growth has essentially stalled flat and preliminary estimates of turnover are off more sharply. In contrast, price growth continues to track a strong pace in the 'mid-sized' capitals of Brisbane, Adelaide and Perth with turnover also rising.

We are yet to see the full effects of the Feb rate hike with a further interest rate rise and the potential for changes in housing-related tax policy there are likely to be more headwinds in coming months.

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